

Author: Daan Eggen

Date: 16/08/2026

Learning Outcome: Personal Leadership

Personal Leadership Reflection

Introduction

This document demonstrates how I take initiative in requesting feedback, reflect on it, and use my core values to guide my academic and professional development. During this project, I identified several issues in my way of working. This reflection connects the feedback I received to concrete actions that will help me become more independent, consistent, and effective.

My Core Values

The following core values guide my development:

- **Responsibility:** I take ownership of my progress and do not wait for someone else to solve a problem.
- **Openness:** I actively request feedback, respond to it, and discuss unclear expectations.
- **Collaboration:** I use the knowledge and motivation of my peers while also contributing to the group.
- **Growth:** I treat feedback and setbacks as information that can improve my approach.
- **Reliability:** I make realistic agreements, record them clearly, and follow up on them.

These values represent the professional I want to become: a software developer who takes initiative, communicates clearly, works independently, and involves others when collaboration can improve the result.

Reflection on Feedback

Motivation Through Peers

I noticed that contact with fellow students helps me remain motivated. Without regular contact, I tend to work in isolation and find it more difficult to maintain momentum. To address this, I agreed with the group to organise regular **expert rounds**. During these sessions, each person shares their progress, expertise, and current challenges.

This gives me a recurring moment to ask for feedback and learn from other students. It also allows me to contribute my own knowledge. In this way, collaboration supports both my motivation and the development of the group.

Lack of Concrete Planning

My planning was previously too general. Tasks were not divided into sufficiently small steps, and they often lacked clear deadlines. This made it difficult to measure my progress and recognise delays early.

For future work, I will divide each larger assignment into subtasks with a specific result and deadline. At least once a week, I will review whether the planning is still achievable. When circumstances change, I will update the planning deliberately instead of allowing deadlines to pass without taking action.

Leaving Feedback Unaddressed

I sometimes read feedback without responding or making it visible what I intended to do with it. As a result, the person providing feedback did not know whether I understood their message. I also missed opportunities to ask questions when the feedback was unclear.

My new personal rule is to respond to every piece of feedback I receive. I will state whether I intend to apply it, address it later, or choose not to follow it for a clear reason. This turns feedback into an active conversation rather than a collection of isolated comments.

Unclear Expectations About Guidance

My expectations of the available guidance did not always match the support that was provided. I waited too long before discussing this difference. As a result, I did not always receive the support I expected, while the supervisor may not have known what I needed.

At the start of a future project, I will discuss what support I need, what the supervisor expects from me, and how often we will review my progress. If the guidance still does not meet the agreed expectations, I will raise the issue early. When necessary, I will discuss whether another supervisor or an additional form of support would be more suitable.

Blocking Planning and Waiting for Dependencies

When my work depended on someone else's planning or an external service, I sometimes waited instead of looking for a way to continue. This unnecessarily delayed my own progress.

As a developer, I can often continue by clearly documenting my assumptions and implementing temporary **stub services**. A stub makes it possible to develop and test the user interface and business logic before the real dependency becomes available. When the final service is ready, I can replace the stub and test the complete integration. This approach allows me to remain productive while still communicating the dependency and its risks.

Personal Action Plan

Development area	Concrete action	Success criterion
Motivation and collaboration	Participate in expert rounds and share my progress and at least one question.	The sessions take place regularly and produce useful feedback or knowledge sharing.
Planning	Divide assignments into subtasks with deadlines and review them weekly.	Every active task has a clear outcome and a realistic deadline.
Processing feedback	Respond within two working days and record what I will do with the feedback.	No received feedback remains without a response or decision.
Aligning guidance	Agree on expectations, responsibilities, and contact moments at the start of a project.	Both parties can explain what was agreed and when it will be evaluated.

Development area	Concrete action	Success criterion
Removing blockers	When an external dependency blocks progress, investigate whether a stub or mock allows work to continue.	I can continue developing and testing independent parts without unnecessary waiting.

Making Feedback Visible

To provide evidence of my development, I will record the following information for each important feedback moment:

1. Who provided the feedback and when it was received.
2. The main point of the feedback.
3. The decision or action that followed.
4. The effect of the change on my work.
5. What I would do differently next time.

During future feedback sessions, I will ask focused questions about my working process instead of only asking whether the product is good enough. Examples include: *“Are my subtasks specific enough to make my progress visible?”* and *“Have I clearly demonstrated what I did with the previous feedback?”*

Conclusion

The main lesson from this feedback is that personal leadership requires me to take action instead of waiting. I need to create structure, communicate expectations, follow up on feedback, and find alternatives when progress is blocked.

My core values of responsibility, openness, collaboration, growth, and reliability provide direction for these improvements. By carrying out the action plan and reviewing the results during future feedback sessions, I can determine whether my approach is genuinely improving and make my development visible.